

TING-WEI LI

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Champaign, IL

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I am interested in **data-centric machine learning**. I work on the full data pipeline for modern AI systems, currently focusing on *data attribution*, *data selection*, *data refinement*, and *data generation* for LLMs and agentic systems. I have authored 15+ papers at top venues including ICML/NeurIPS/ICLR, with 250+ citations.

EDUCATION

- **University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign** Champaign, IL
Ph.D. in Computer Science 08/2024 - Present
Advisor: Prof. [Hanghang Tong](#)
GPA: 4.0/4.0; Expected graduation: 12/2028
- **University of Michigan, Ann Arbor** Ann Arbor, MI
M.Sc. in Electrical and Computer Engineering 08/2021 - 04/2023
GPA: 4.0/4.0
- **National Taiwan University** Taipei, Taiwan
B.S.Eng in Electrical Engineering 09/2016 - 06/2020
GPA: 3.9/4.3

EXPERIENCE

- **Meta Platforms, Inc.**
Part-Time Student Researcher @Ads 08/2026 - Present, Remote, IL
 - Developed efficient data selection methods tailored for large-scale Ads recommendation models.
 - Mentors: Amit Anand Amlesahwaram, Bill Huang**Research Intern @Ads** 05/2026 - 08/2026, Sunnyvale, CA
 - Developed gradient-based data attribution methods tailored for large-scale Ads recommendation models.
 - Mentors: Amit Anand Amlesahwaram, Bill Huang
- **Amazon.com, Inc.**
Applied Scientist Intern @Prime Video 05/2025 - 08/2025, Seattle, WA
 - Designed an efficient multi-task learning framework for a large-scale video platform.
 - Mentors: Cody Severinski, Changhe Yuan
- **AT&T Inc.**
Research Intern @AT&T Labs 09/2023 - 11/2023, Bedminster, NJ
 - Developed interpretable graph-based models for large-scale customer behavior analysis.
 - Mentors: Qiong Wu, Zhengyi Zhou, Eric Zavesky

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

1. **Ting-Wei Li**, Yuanchen Bei, Xiao Lin, Hanghang Tong. “*Beyond LLM-Based Reasoning: Lightweight GNNs for Agent Failure Attribution*”. In **Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)** 2026. [\[Paper\]](#).
2. **Ting-Wei Li**, Sirui Chen, Jiaru Zou, Yingbing Huang, Tianxin Wei, Jingrui He, Hanghang Tong. “*EvoSelect: Data-Efficient LLM Evolution for Targeted Task Adaptation*”. In **Conference on Language Modeling (COLM)** 2026. [\[Paper\]](#).
3. Tianxin Wei*, **Ting-Wei Li***, Zhining Liu* et al. “*A Survey of Agentic Reasoning for Large Language Models: Towards Recursively Self-Improving and Collective Agents*”. In **Transactions on Machine Learning Research (TMLR)** 2026 (**Hugging Face Weekly #1 Paper**). [\[Paper\]](#).

4. Xuying Ning, Dongqi Fu, Tianxin Wei, Mengting Ai, Jiaru Zou, **Ting-Wei Li**, Hanghang Tong, Yada Zhu, Hendrik Hamann, Jingrui He. “*MC-Search: Evaluating and Enhancing Multimodal Agentic Search with Structured Long Reasoning Chains*”. In **International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR) 2026 Oral**. [Paper].
5. Ruizhong Qiu*, **Ting-Wei Li***, Gaotang Li, Hanghang Tong. “*Graph Homophily Booster: Rethinking the Role of Discrete Features on Heterophilic Graphs*”. In **International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR) 2026**. [Paper].
6. Hyunsik Yoo, **Ting-Wei Li**, SeongKu Kang, Zhining Liu, Charlie Xu, Qilin Qi, Hanghang Tong. “*Continual Low-Rank Adapters for LLM-based Generative Recommender Systems*”. In **International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR) 2026**. [Paper].
7. **Ting-Wei Li**, Ruizhong Qiu, Hanghang Tong. “*Graph Data Selection for Domain Adaptation: A Model-Free Approach*”. In **Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS) 2025**. [Paper] [Poster].
8. Junwei Deng*, **Ting-Wei Li***, Shiyuan Zhang, Shixuan Liu, Yijun Pan, Hao Huang, Xinhe Wang, Pingbang Hu, Xingjian Zhang, Jiaqi W Ma. “*dattri: A Library for Efficient Data Attribution*”. In **Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS) 2024 Spotlight**. [Paper] [Code] [Poster].
9. Junwei Deng*, **Ting-Wei Li***, Shichang Zhang, Jiaqi Ma. “*Efficient Ensembles Improve Training Data Attribution*”. In **Transactions on Machine Learning Research (TMLR) 2024**. [Paper].
10. **Ting-Wei Li**, Qiaozhu Mei, Jiaqi Ma. “*A Metadata-Driven Approach to Understand Graph Neural Networks*”. In **Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS) 2023**. [Paper] [Code] [Poster].

(* indicates equal contribution)

PREPRINTS AND SUBMISSIONS

1. **Ting-Wei Li**, Ernie Chang, Yuanchen Bei, Narine Kokhlikyan, Hanghang Tong. “*HyperBridge: Effectively Adapting Hypernetworks across LLM Architectures*”. In **Arxiv 2026 (In submission to ICLR)**.
2. Xuying Ning, Katherine Tieu, Dongqi Fu, Tianxin Wei, Zihao Li, Yuanchen Bei, Jiaru Zou, Mengting Ai, Zhining Liu, **Ting-Wei Li** et al. “*Code as Agent Harness: Toward Executable, Verifiable, and Stateful Agent Systems*”. In **Arxiv 2026**. [Paper].
3. Xinrui He, **Ting-Wei Li**, Juntong Wang, Mengting Ai, Xinyu He, Hanghang Tong, Jingrui He. “*Harnessing Image Question Dependence for Better VLM Test-time Reinforcement Learning*”. In **Arxiv 2026 (In submission to ICLR)**. [Paper].
4. Ruizhong Qiu*, **Ting-Wei Li***, Gaotang Li*, Tianxin Wei, Jingrui He, Hanghang Tong. “*Efficient Inference Scaling for Safety Assurance*”. In **Arxiv 2025**. [Paper].
5. Junwei Deng*, Yuzheng Hu*, Pingbang Hu*, **Ting-Wei Li***, Shixuan Liu* et al. “*A Survey of Data Attribution: Methods, Applications, and Evaluation in the Era of Generative AI*”. In **SSRN 2025 (In submission to JAIR)**. [Paper].

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SKILLS

- **Programming:** Python, C++, Bash
- **ML & LLM Frameworks:** PyTorch, Hugging Face, vLLM, TRL, verl, PEFT
- **AI-Native Development:** Claude Code, Claude CLI, Cursor

SELECTED AWARDS & HONORS

- **Scholar Award**, Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems 2023
- **Graduate Student Research Assistant Tuition Waiver**, University of Michigan 2023

TALKS

- **Agentic Reasoning for Large Language Models**, [NLP Academic Exchange Platform](#) 2026
- **Data Attribution for GenAI Copyright**, [Data Attribution Reading Group](#) 2024

PROFESSIONAL SERVICES

- **Conference Reviewer**
 - ACM Web Conference (WWW) 2027
 - IEEE/CVF International Conference on Computer Vision (ICCV) 2025
 - Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS) 2025, 2026
 - International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR) 2025, 2026, 2027
 - International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML) 2024, 2025, 2026
 - IEEE International Conference on Big Data (Big Data) 2023
 - IEEE International Conference on Data Mining Workshop on Machine Learning on Graphs (ICDM MLoG) 2023
- **Program Committee**
 - AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence (AAAI) 2025, 2026, 2027
 - IEEE International Conference on Data Science and Advanced Analytics (DSAA) 2024
- **Organizer Team**
 - [Data Foundations of AI](#) Seminar Coordinator
 - [Data Attribution Reading Group](#) Speaker, Organization Member

MENTORING EXPERIENCE

- **Mr. Wei-Chi Wu (Exchange B.S. Student, UIUC CS)** 2026 - Now
 - Hypernetworks for non-text data and domain adaptation.
- **Ms. Thota Hima (B.S. Student, UIUC CS)** 2026 - Now
 - Evolving semantic tokenization for LLM-based continual recommendation systems.
- **Ms. Jianing Li (B.S. Student, UIUC CS)** 2025 - 2026
 - Graph-augmented LLM-based recommendation systems.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

- University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, **CS 412: Introduction to Data Mining** Spring 2026